

China Consumer Durables: EU anti-dumping investigation on Chinese RLMs to continue but not imposing provisional duties at this time

The News

The European Commission initiated an anti-dumping investigation on robotic lawn mowers from China in Nov 2025 in response to a complaint ([link](#)) by Husqvarna (not covered), a global leader in RLM etc. According to the notice, the EU may: 1) impose provisional measures (e.g., provisional anti-dumping duties) in no later than seven months of the announcement (June 19, 2026); 2) conclude the investigation within one year (Nov 19, 2026), but no more than 14 months upon the announcement (Jan 19, 2027). On Jun 19, 2026, the EU announced that it will continue the anti-dumping investigation rather than imposing provisional measures at the current stage, given the technical complexity of the case ([link](#)).

Our view

While we take no view on the EU's decision, we believe investors could view the update positively with the decision to hold off on imposing provisional measures on Chinese robotic lawn mowers (RLM) players suggesting limited near-term impact to sales performance and margins. In our previous analysis ([link](#)), we noted that most Chinese players plans were to ship a majority of their 2026 sales target to Europe by 1H26 with expectations to start to bear the impact of potential provisional anti-dumping duties from June 2026. In light of the recent announcement, the applicable tariff rate will probably remain unchanged in 2026, which should help preserve Chinese RLM players' near-term margins and market competitiveness (considering they may not need to increase prices to mitigate tariff impacts). In the meantime, we continue to expect Chinese RLM players to exert discipline in terms of pricing strategy, at least until there is more clarity around any potential impact from the investigation.

The above said, uncertainty remains as the EU continues the anti-dumping investigation and may still decide to impose an anti-dumping tariff duty with retrospective effects upon completion. However, the current announcement leaves a longer time window for Chinese players to prepare for potential duties, such as relocating manufacturing capacity overseas. We note that manufacturing costs generally increase by 10%-20% in early stage relocation due to less efficient labor productivity and supply chain. A longer preparation time could help improve efficiency in the event of a relocation, though not entirely eliminating the gap.

In our coverage, we think shares of Ninebot, Ecovacs and Roborock could react positively to the announcement with Ninebot likely being the largest beneficiary

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given its higher exposure to robotic lawn mowers (9% of total revenue and a higher profits contribution in 2025). We continue to believe that leading brands including Ninebot (Buy) are better positioned (vs. small players) to cope with any potential tariff impacts due to the higher pricing position of their products, and their ability to adjust production globally if needed. Specifically for Ninebot, the EU anti-dumping investigation has been one of the overhangs for its valuation, and we believe the latest announcement could help ease investor sentiment at least in the near term.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Ninebot Ltd (689009.SS, Buy)

Investment thesis: We expect Ninebot to grow as an emerging global leader in micro-mobility and robotic lawn mowers, driven by: 1) Further market share gain in core domestic E2W with rising membership fee contribution supported by its product R&D strength as smart functions play a more important role in products, together with channel expansion and wider product offerings via its dual-brand; 2) Rapidly growing robotic lawn mower business riding on the structural growth of robotic adoption vs. traditional. We view Ninebot as better positioned to gain share leveraging its comprehensive product portfolio, established brand, and stronger presence in the offline channel; 3) Overseas expansion potential: We see near-term revenue and profits opportunities from E-Bikes in developed markets, benefiting from the rising electrification adoption on policy support and rising consumer preference for environment-friendly products. The fragmented market also leaves room for Chinese players like Ninebot to gain share leveraging its accumulated technology and competitive products. In the mid to long-run, we see substantial revenue potential in emerging markets such as ASEAN countries where there is large ICE 2W ownership, current E2W adoption is low and the electric transition has been ongoing driven by supportive government policies.

Valuation: Our 12-month target price of Rmb62 is based on a 16x exit P/E multiple applied to our 2028E EPS and discounted back to 2027E using a 9.5% cost of equity.

Key risks: 1) Decline in disposable income and consumer confidence from weaker macro conditions; 2) Slower-than-expected product launches or new category expansion; 3) Intensifying competition in domestic/overseas markets; 4) Potential tariffs/anti-dumping duties may reduce profitability; 5) Higher-than-expected raw materials cost.

Beijing Roborock Technology (688169.SS, Buy)

Investment Thesis: Roborock is a global leader in robotic vacuum cleaners (RVCs) with an expanding product range and channel expansion growth runway. We believe the company is well-placed for continued global market share gains, driven by: 1) further progress in channel expansion especially in overseas markets; 2) enhanced marketing and branding investment; 3) SKU expansion outside of its core RVC products, such as wet dry vacuums and robotic lawn mowers. Since the company adopted a more proactive branding/marketing strategy in 2H24, the company has been gaining share at a faster pace in both overseas and domestic markets. With most of the previous margin drags (i.e., over-investment in new product, US tariff, Europe business model transition,

and self-borne subsidies in China) generally lifted, we see favorable risk-reward in the shares on re-rating prospects as the company resumes fast profit growth driven by resilient revenue growth and strong margin recovery.

Valuation: Our 12-m TP of Rmb170 is based on a 18x exit P/E multiple applied to our 2028E EPS and discounted back to 2027E using a 9.5% cost of equity.

Downside risks: 1) intensifying competition in domestic/overseas markets; 2) slower-than-expected product launches or new category expansion; 3) aggressive branding/marketing investment in new products to impact profitability; 4) a decline in disposable income and consumer confidence from weaker macro conditions; 5) potential increase in US tariffs may reduce US business profitability.

Ecovacs Robotics Co. (603486.SS, Sell)

Investment Thesis: Ecovacs, the leading cleaning appliances company by market share in China, has strengths in a comprehensive product portfolio and distribution network (both offline and online) leveraging a dual-brand strategy (Ecovacs for RVC and Tineco for wet-dry vacuums and other small appliances). While we remain positive on 1) the long-term potential of cleaning appliances especially RVC in both the domestic and overseas markets and 2) Ecovacs' market share gain potential overseas, we are cautious about competition for cleaning appliances in the domestic market, especially for wet-dry vacuums, as well as the challenges in defending its market share without hurting margins. We see less favorable risk-reward for Ecovacs vs. its peers and are Sell rated.

Valuation: Our 12-m target price of Rmb55 is based on an exit multiple of 17x applied to our 2028E EPS and discounted back to 2027E using a 9.5% cost of equity.

Upside risks: 1) faster demand recovery supported by better-than-expected macro conditions; 2) better-than-expected product development/expansion; 3) easing competition.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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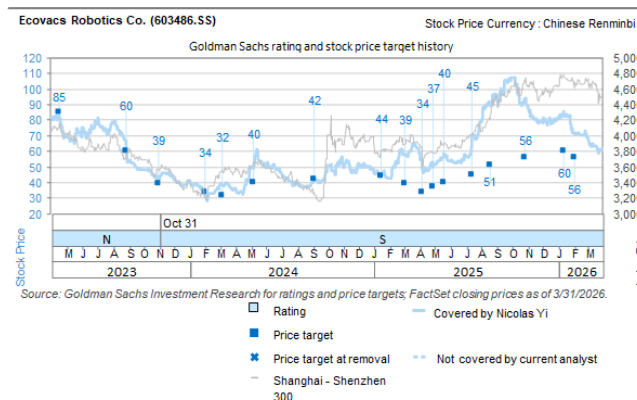
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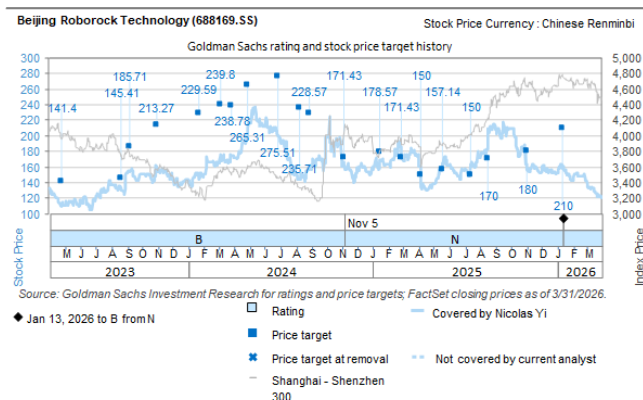
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Target price history table(s)

Ninebot Ltd (689009.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
02-Apr-26	62.00	43.48

Ecovacs Robotics Co. (603486.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
27-Apr-26	55.00	67.80
15-Apr-26	49.00	62.61
02-Feb-26	56.00	71.42
13-Jan-26	60.00	83.41
27-Oct-25	56.00	93.85
19-Aug-25	51.00	89.20
15-Jul-25	45.00	70.43
19-May-25	40.00	57.42
28-Apr-25	37.00	49.68
08-Apr-25	34.00	46.22
03-Mar-25	39.00	57.90
16-Jan-25	44.00	44.85
03-Sep-24	42.00	42.00
08-May-24	40.00	49.25
05-Mar-24	32.00	38.39
31-Jan-24	34.00	31.97
31-Oct-23	39.00	43.16
28-Aug-23	60.00	60.26

Beijing Roborock Technology (688169.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
27-Apr-26	170.00	118.68
15-Apr-26	180.00	113.62
13-Jan-26	210.00	158.53
03-Nov-25	180.00	156.97
18-Aug-25	170.00	209.04
15-Jul-25	150.00	163.70
19-May-25	220.00	156.99
07-Apr-25	210.00	134.34
28-Feb-25	240.00	170.71
16-Jan-25	250.00	169.50
05-Nov-24	240.00	166.59
29-Aug-24	320.00	157.13
09-Aug-24	330.00	144.89
27-Jun-24	540.00	200.61
30-Apr-24	520.00	216.85
28-Mar-24	468.00	174.45
05-Mar-24	470.00	174.34
24-Jan-24	450.00	146.94

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
31-Oct-23	418.00	161.22
08-Sep-23	364.00	155.39
22-Aug-23	285.00	130.62

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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